



FINTECH



Cash App users can now pool money for group payments — even with non-users

\$500 pool

Cash App [launched](#) a new peer-to-peer payment feature on Tuesday called “pools” that allows users to pool money with friends or family members to pay for expenses like grocery bills, restaurant checks, vacations, and group gifts. Initially available to select users, it will expand more widely in the coming months.

Users can create pools through the payment tab by setting a target amount and inviting contributors via their \$cashtag or texting a link to non-users to pay through Apple Pay or Google Pay.

~~The organizer can close the pool anytime and transfer the funds to their Cash balance.~~

IMAGE CREDITS: CASH APP

The ability for non-users to contribute through Apple Pay and Google Pay is particularly significant, as it encourages participation from those not on the app. The platform needs growth after reporting that consumers used the app less than expected, leading to a [first-quarter gross profit](#) that fell short of its projections.

This move comes as Cash App seeks to compete with [Venmo](#) and [PayPal](#), which both offer money-pooling capabilities.

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Lauren Forristal

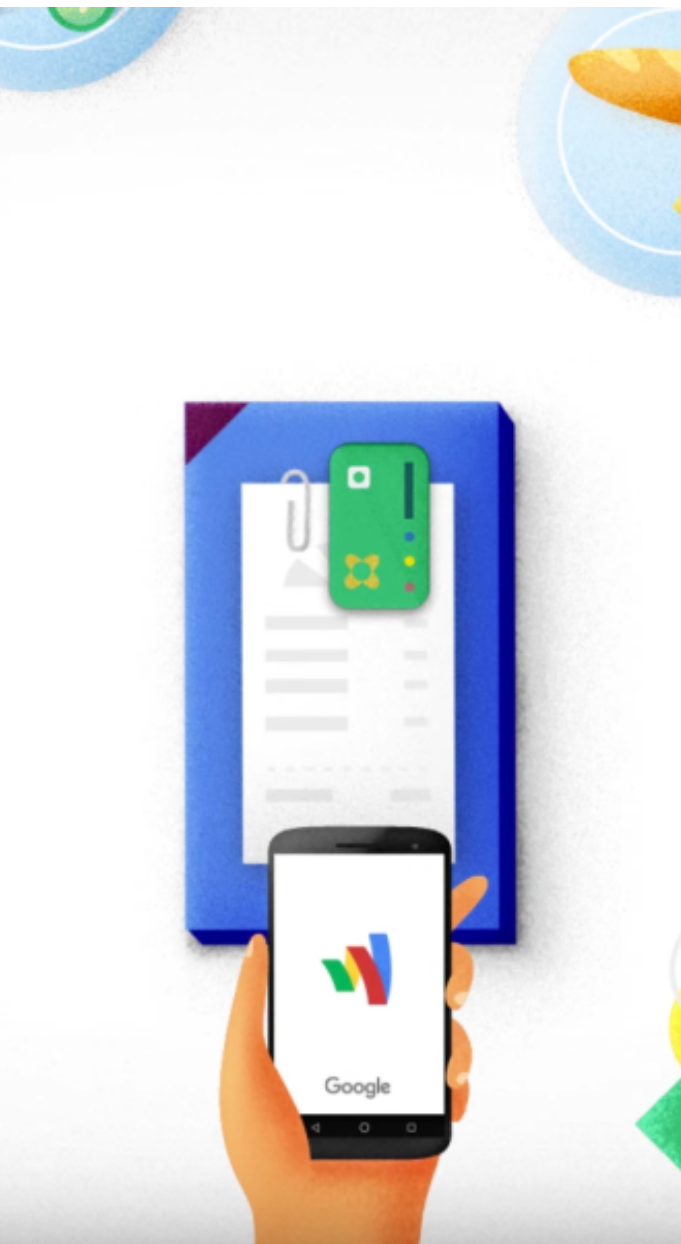


Lauren covers media, streaming, apps and platforms at TechCrunch.

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Google Wallet debuts automatic transfers so you can skip “cashing out”

Sarah Perez — 11:58 AM PDT · August 26, 2016

Google today is stepping up its battle with Venmo, Square Cash and other person-to-person payment

applications with an update to its [Google Wallet](#) mobile app, which now allows for automatic transfers to your bank account. That is, transfers will no longer require you to cash out money from your Wallet balance first. This will speed up the time it takes for Wallet users to gain access to their cash, something that has been slower in the past.

The feature was announced in the app's update text on Friday, but we understand the feature will actually begin rolling out gradually, starting next week.

As you may recall, Google Wallet transitioned to [become a peer-to-peer payments app](#) last year following the [launch of Android Pay](#), Google's Apple Pay rival now used at point-of-sale and for in-app purchases on Android devices. Earlier this year, the company [also dropped support for the physical, plastic Google Wallet card](#) associated with the app, as it continued its transition to p2p payments.

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factors – like who you bank with, or whether you're crediting the money back to a debit card. Transfers to debit cards will be instant in most cases, though some banks may take 24 hours to process those transactions. Meanwhile, transfers to banks should take 1 to 3 days.

This change also means that when you send money to friends, those funds will also be able to go to their bank accounts automatically, without any waiting time for them.



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Of course, you'll still be able to keep money in your Google Wallet balance if you want to – that option is not going away.

There will still be times when transfers take longer, though, as with any other payments service. Google may need to run fraud checks or may need to perform additional verification of user accounts, on occasion.

However, the move to bypass the “cash out” process could help Google Wallet better compete against the growing number of digital payment services, including PayPal and PayPal-owned Venmo, Square Cash, and even social networks like [Facebook](#) and [Snapchat](#), which have experimented with bundling in payments to their messaging apps.



[Apple, too, will soon support payments in iMessage](#), as powered by Square Cash.

Square Cash powers Snapchat's payment system, too, but it [only this year added the option to hold a balance through an optional "Cash Drawer" setting](#). With the update, Google is moving like Square Cash in reverse. It already had the cash drawer option; now it can transfer the money more quickly, too.

Topics: [google wallet](#) [Media & Entertainment](#)

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Sarah Perez

Consumer News Editor | [X](#) [b](#) [@](#) [in](#)

Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having...

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PayPal launches 'Tap to Pay' on iPhone for U.S. businesses using Venmo and Zettle

Aisha Malik — 8:52 AM PST · March 7, 2024

IMAGE CREDITS:

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PayPal [announced](#) today that it's launching "Tap to Pay" for merchants with an iPhone through the Venmo and Zettle apps in the U.S. PayPal, which owns both Venmo and Zettle, says the feature will allow businesses to accept contactless card and digital wallet payments directly on their iPhones with no additional cost or hardware. The launch comes eight months after PayPal [introduced the feature](#) for merchants with Android phones.

In addition to being able to accept payments from cards or digital wallets like Apple Pay or Google Pay, Tap to Pay allows merchants to add taxes, accept tips, send receipts and issue refunds

without any additional hardware. Funds from sales are quickly put into a business's Venmo or PayPal Zettle account, the company says. PayPal charges 2.29% + 9¢ for every sale through the tap-to-pay method across Zettle and Venmo.

With Tap to Pay on iPhone, Venmo business profile users will be able to reach for customers by accepting payments from buyers even if they don't have a Venmo account. Merchants can manage both their Venmo and card payment transactions directly within the Venmo app.

The official launch of the feature comes a few months after PayPal began testing it through an early access program.

The launch of the new feature comes two years after PayPal rival Stripe became [Apple's first payment partner](#) for Tap to Pay. A year later, Stripe enabled businesses to carry out Tap to Pay transactions on [NFC-equipped Android devices](#), as well. Stripe charges \$0.10 per transaction for Tap to Pay purchases using its Stripe payment gateway, with additional charges for card and digital wallet payments.

As consumers are [increasingly going cashless](#), PayPal says Tap to Pay on iPhone will help millions of small businesses adapt to the shift in consumer behavior, as it removes the need to for merchants to purchase card readers.



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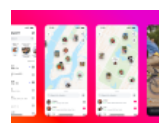
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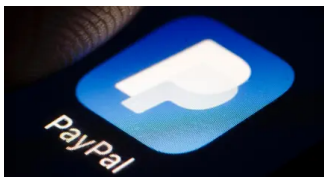
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PayPal suggests it will be ready to offer 'offline' payments when DMA goes into effect



PayPal is working on a new consumer app for its mobile customers, and suggested that it will be “ready” to take advantage of the new EU regulation, the Digital Markets Act (DMA), when it

goes into effect next month for tech “gatekeepers,” like Apple. For PayPal, one of the significant changes coming in the DMA

Topics: [Apps](#) [Apps](#) [PayPal](#) [Venmo](#)



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Consumer News Reporter | [X](#)

Aisha is a consumer news reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining the publication in 2021, she was a telecom reporte...

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